HEAVY INDUSTRIES

ELECTRIC DREAMS

The push for domestic manufacture of electric vehicles bodes well for the future

By Anilesh S. Mahajan



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Mahendra Nath Pandey
Minister of Heavy Industries and Public Enterprises

IF THERE'S ONE MINISTRY that has the potential to show results quickly in the Aatmanirbhar Bharat campaign, it has to be Mahendra Nath Pandey's heavy industries. The ministry is anchoring the country's efforts to build an ecosystem for manufacturing new-age electric vehicles. The two phases of Faster Adoption and Manufacturing of Electric (& Hybrid) Vehicles (FAME) India has already witnessed the production of 7,090 e-buses, 500,000 e-three wheelers, 55,000 e-four wheeler passenger cars (including strong hybrids) and 1 million e-two wheelers. Pandey's ministry is already supplying 6,315 electric buses to 65 cities for intra-city operations. Separately, the PSU Bharat Heavy Electricals Ltd (BHEL) is preparing to indigenously build 1,000 MW ultra super-critical electricity manufacturing units. If successful, it will be one of the most advanced power generation units. ■

WHAT'S DONE

- PLI scheme for automobile and auto components rolled out
- Two phases of FAME anchored the entry of electric vehicles in India
- Launched GW scale battery storage manufacturing plan under the National Programme on Advanced Chemistry Cell (ACC) Battery Storage

CHALLENGES AHEAD

- Improve the structuring of BHEL for disinvestment
- Make e-vehicles more speed worthy, compliant for highways and expressways
- Complete the manufacturing process for the 1,000 MW ultra super critical thermal unit by BHEL



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INDUSTRY AND TEXTILES

A GREAT SUPPORT SYSTEM

Dedicated ecosystems for industry, start-ups and textiles will go a long way in boosting these sectors

By Anilesh S. Mahajan